



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Bible Heroes & Their Faith: A Study Workbook

The Real Stories, Failures, and Faith of Scripture's Great Figures - For Ages 13-19



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class

HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

The Bible's heroes weren't superhuman - they were flawed people who trusted (and sometimes failed) an extraordinary God. This six-unit study digs into Abraham, Moses, Esther, David, Daniel, and ultimately Jesus, asking what their faith demands of yours. For ages 13 to 19.

HEBREWS 12:1

"Therefore, since we are surrounded by such a great cloud of witnesses..."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Abraham: The Faith to Go

"By faith Abraham... obeyed and went, even though he did not know where he was going." - Hebrews 11:8

Unit Overview

Abraham left everything on God's promise. His life models faith that obeys before it understands, and trusts God with the unknown.

DEVOTIONAL

Leaving the Familiar

God's first command to Abraham was to leave - home, security, plans - for a destination not yet revealed.

GENESIS 12:1

"The Lord had said to Abram, 'Go from your country, your people and your father's household to the land I will show you.'"

Abraham had to trust the Promiser before he could see the promise. Faith often moves before it sees.

God rarely shows the whole path at once; he asks for the next step of trust.

Reflect

1. What 'familiar' thing might God be asking you to hold loosely?

2. Where do you want the whole map before you'll take a step?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, give me faith to obey the next step even when I can't see the whole path.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Counted as Righteous

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

GENESIS 15:5-6

"He took him outside and said, 'Look up at the sky and count the stars - if indeed you can count them.' Then he said to him, 'So shall your offspring be.' Abram believed the Lord, and he credited it to him as righteousness."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does God ask Abram to look at?

2. What does God promise?

3. What was 'credited' to Abram, and why?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Counted as Righteous

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is Abram's belief - not his works - counted as righteousness?

2. How does this preview the whole gospel?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you need to simply believe God's promise?

2. How does faith, not performance, change how you relate to God?

WORD STUDY

Righteousness

MEANING

Being right with God. In the gospel, it is credited to us through faith, not earned by works.

Where It Appears**ROMANS 4:3**

"Abraham believed God, and it was credited to him as righteousness."

2 CORINTHIANS 5:21

"God made him... to be sin for us, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God."

Dig Deeper

1. Why is credited righteousness such good news?

2. How does this free you from trying to earn God's approval?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Step of Faith

Where is God asking you to trust him with an unknown?

What fears hold you back?

What would obedience look like this week?

FAITH & WORLDVIEW

Isn't Faith Just Wishful Thinking?

THE QUESTION

How is trusting God different from hoping something works out?

Think It Through**Based on a track record**

Abraham trusted God because of who God had shown himself to be, not blind optimism.

Costly, not convenient

Real faith often demands sacrifice - the opposite of comfortable wishing.

Relational trust

Faith is trusting a Person, like trusting a proven friend, not gambling on luck.

Your Response

1. How would you explain the difference between faith and wishful thinking?

2. What has built - or shaken - your trust in God?

UNIT 2

Moses: From Excuses to Obedience

"Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh?" - Exodus 3:11

Unit Overview

Moses felt unqualified and made excuses, yet God used him powerfully. His story speaks to insecurity, calling, and God's sufficiency.

DEVOTIONAL

Feeling Unqualified

Moses' response to God's call was a list of reasons he was the wrong guy. God wasn't deterred.

EXODUS 4:10

"Moses said to the Lord, 'Pardon your servant, Lord. I have never been eloquent... I am slow of speech and tongue.'"

God's answer wasn't 'You're amazing, actually.' It was 'I will be with you.' The qualification is God's presence, not our resume.

Feeling inadequate isn't disqualifying; refusing to trust the God who calls you is.

Reflect

1. Where do you feel unqualified for something God might be asking?

2. How does 'I will be with you' change the equation?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, when I feel inadequate, remind me that you go with me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Call and the Excuse

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

EXODUS 3:10-12

"So now, go. I am sending you to Pharaoh to bring my people the Israelites out of Egypt.' But Moses said to God, 'Who am I that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the Israelites out of Egypt?' And God said, 'I will be with you. And this will be the sign to you that it is I who have sent you: When you have brought the people out of Egypt, you will worship God on this mountain.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What is God's command?

2. What is Moses' objection?

3. What is God's core reassurance?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Call and the Excuse

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does God answer 'Who am I?' with 'I will be with you' instead of praising Moses?

2. What does that teach about calling?

Application - What will I do?

1. What excuse are you hiding behind?

2. How would you act if you truly believed God was with you?

WORD STUDY

Calling

MEANING

God's summons to a person for his purposes - often to something beyond their comfort or ability.

Where It Appears**1 THESSALONIANS 5:24**

"The one who calls you is faithful, and he will do it."

ROMANS 11:29

"God's gifts and his call are irrevocable."

Dig Deeper

1. What might God be calling you toward, even in small ways, right now?

2. How is God's faithfulness the key to answering a calling?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Excuses

What excuses do you make when God nudges you?

What insecurity is underneath them?

What would trusting God's presence change?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Everyone feels unqualified sometimes. Be honest together.

1. Where do people our age feel 'not enough'?

2. How does comparison feed our excuses?

3. How can this group encourage each other's callings?

UNIT 3

Esther: The Right Person at the Right Time

"For such a time as this." - Esther 4:14

Unit Overview

Esther used her position and took a great risk for others. Her story is about influence, timing, and courage to act.

DEVOTIONAL

Your Position on Purpose

You didn't land in your school, family, or friend group by accident. God positions people.

ESTHER 4:14

"And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?"

Esther's crown wasn't just a privilege; it was a platform for others' good.

Wherever you have influence - however small - is a place God can use you for someone else's rescue.

Reflect

1. Where do you have influence you tend to overlook?

2. Who might need you to use it for their good?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me use where you've placed me for others, not just myself.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Deciding to Act

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

ESTHER 4:13-16

"Mordecai sent back this answer: 'Do not think that because you are in the king's house you alone of all the Jews will escape... And who knows but that you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?' Then Esther sent this reply: 'Go, gather together all the Jews... and fast for me... When this is done, I will go to the king, even though it is against the law. And if I perish, I perish.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What warning does Mordecai give Esther?

2. What does Esther ask for first?

3. What is her final decision?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Deciding to Act

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Esther seek prayer/fasting before acting?

2. What does her resolve cost her?

Application - What will I do?

1. What right thing have you been avoiding out of fear?

2. What would preparing and then acting look like?

WORD STUDY

Providence

MEANING

God's unseen guidance of events toward his good purposes - evident in Esther though God is never named.

Where It Appears**PROVERBS 19:21**

"Many are the plans in a person's heart, but it is the Lord's purpose that prevails."

PROVERBS 16:9

"In their hearts humans plan their course, but the Lord establishes their steps."

Dig Deeper

1. How does providence encourage you when life feels random?

2. Where might God be working behind the scenes in your life?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Moment

What influence has God given you?

Is there a courageous, right action you're avoiding?

What would 'if I perish, I perish' resolve look like for you?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Use Your Position

Influence unused is influence wasted. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Stand up for someone who can't stand up for themselves.
- ☐ Use a talent or platform to serve, not just to shine.
- ☐ Do one brave, right thing you've been putting off.
- ☐ Pray before you act, like Esther did.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

David: A Heart After God

"The Lord looks at the heart." - 1 Samuel 16:7

Unit Overview

David was a hero and a failure - brave, worshipful, and deeply flawed. His life teaches worship, repentance, and what God values.

DEVOTIONAL

What God Sees

When God chose David, everyone was looking at his older, taller brothers. God was looking somewhere else.

1 SAMUEL 16:7

"The Lord does not look at the things people look at. People look at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart."

In a world obsessed with image, God evaluates the heart - motives, devotion, character.

David wasn't chosen for his looks or resume, but for a heart oriented toward God (even when he failed).

Reflect

1. What 'outward appearance' do you worry about most?

2. What is the current condition of your heart toward God?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, you see my heart. Make it more devoted to you than to my image.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Broken and Contrite Heart

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PSALM 51:1-4, 10

"Have mercy on me, O God, according to your unfailing love; according to your great compassion blot out my transgressions... Against you, you only, have I sinned and done what is evil in your sight... Create in me a pure heart, O God, and renew a steadfast spirit within me."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What does David ask God to do with his sin?

2. Who does David say he sinned against?

3. What does he ask God to create?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Broken and Contrite Heart

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. What does true repentance look like here?

2. Why does David focus on his heart, not just his behavior?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you need to pray Psalm 51 honestly?

2. What does 'create in me a pure heart' mean for you?

WORD STUDY

Repentance

MEANING

A turning - changing your mind and direction, away from sin and back toward God.

Where It Appears**ACTS 3:19**

"Repent, then, and turn to God, so that your sins may be wiped out."

2 CORINTHIANS 7:10

"Godly sorrow brings repentance that leads to salvation."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between guilt and true repentance?

2. How is repentance good news rather than mere punishment?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Condition of My Heart

What does God see in your heart that others don't?

Where do you need to repent and turn back?

Write your own short 'Psalm 51' prayer.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

David was both hero and failure. That's oddly encouraging.

1. Why does the Bible show its heroes' failures?

2. How does David's story give hope after failure?

3. What does a 'heart after God' look like day to day?

UNIT 5

Daniel: Faithful in a Foreign Culture

"Daniel resolved not to defile himself." - Daniel 1:8

Unit Overview

Daniel thrived in a pagan empire without compromising his faith. His life models conviction, wisdom, and prayer under pressure.

DEVOTIONAL

Deciding in Advance

Daniel didn't wait until pressure hit to decide who he'd be. He resolved beforehand.

DANIEL 1:8

"But Daniel resolved not to defile himself with the royal food and wine."

Convictions decided in the moment usually lose to pressure. Daniel decided in advance and held firm with grace.

You can honor God inside a culture that doesn't share your faith - with wisdom, not just defiance.

Reflect

1. What convictions do you need to settle before you're tested?

2. Where does your culture pressure you to 'defile' your convictions?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, help me decide in advance to honor you, and to do it wisely.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Prayer Under Threat

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DANIEL 6:10

"Now when Daniel learned that the decree had been published, he went home to his upstairs room where the windows opened toward Jerusalem. Three times a day he got down on his knees and prayed, giving thanks to his God, just as he had done before."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What had just been made illegal?

2. What did Daniel do anyway?

3. What phrase shows this wasn't new for him?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Prayer Under Threat

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is 'just as he had done before' significant?

2. How did habit prepare Daniel for crisis?

Application - What will I do?

1. What spiritual habits are you building now for future pressure?

2. Would your routine survive if it became costly?

WORD STUDY

Faithfulness

MEANING

Steady loyalty and reliability - being consistent with God over the long haul.

Where It Appears**MATTHEW 25:21**

"Well done, good and faithful servant!"

1 CORINTHIANS 4:2

"It is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful."

Dig Deeper

1. What does faithfulness look like when no one notices?

2. Where do you need more consistency with God?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Faith in My Culture

Where does your environment pressure your faith?

What convictions do you want to settle now?

What daily habit would strengthen you?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Build a Rhythm

Daniel's crisis courage came from daily faithfulness. Start now.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Pray at a set time each day this week.
- ☐ Decide one conviction in advance and write it down.
- ☐ Honor God at school or work in one visible, gracious way.
- ☐ Give thanks daily, like Daniel did, even under stress.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

The Ultimate Hero: Jesus

"Fixing our eyes on Jesus, the pioneer and perfecter of faith." - Hebrews 12:2

Unit Overview

Every hero pointed forward to Jesus, who alone lived perfectly and rescued us. This unit centers faith on him, not just admirable examples.

DEVOTIONAL

More Than an Example

The Bible's heroes inspire us, but they all needed rescue too. Only Jesus is both the example and the Savior.

HEBREWS 12:2

"Let us fix our eyes on Jesus, the pioneer and perfecter of faith."

Abraham, Moses, David, and Daniel all failed. Jesus alone never did - and he died and rose to save the very heroes we admire.

Don't just try to imitate the heroes; trust the One they were all pointing to.

Reflect

1. Have you treated Jesus mainly as an example to copy or a Savior to trust?

2. How does fixing your eyes on Jesus change your faith?

PRAYER PROMPT

Jesus, you are more than a hero to admire. Be my Savior and Lord.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Faith of Jesus

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

PHILIPPIANS 2:5-8

"In your relationships with one another, have the same mindset as Christ Jesus: Who, being in very nature God, did not consider equality with God something to be used to his own advantage; rather, he made himself nothing by taking the very nature of a servant... And being found in appearance as a man, he humbled himself by becoming obedient to death - even death on a cross!"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What did Jesus not cling to?

2. What did he take on instead?

3. How far did his obedience go?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Faith of Jesus

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. How is Jesus the ultimate model of humility and obedience?

2. Why does it matter that God himself served and died?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you cling to advantage instead of serving?

2. How can you have 'the same mindset' this week?

WORD STUDY

Savior

MEANING

One who rescues. Jesus is the Savior who does for us what no hero could do for themselves - defeat sin and death.

Where It Appears**LUKE 2:11**

"Today in the town of David a Savior has been born to you; he is the Messiah, the Lord."

ACTS 4:12

"Salvation is found in no one else."

Dig Deeper

1. Why do we need a Savior and not just good role models?

2. What does it mean to trust Jesus as your Savior personally?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Fixing My Eyes

Which Bible hero encouraged you most, and why?

How is Jesus greater than all of them?

Write a prayer fixing your eyes on Jesus.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. All the heroes point to Christ.

1. Which hero's faith challenged you most?

2. How will you keep 'fixing your eyes on Jesus' after this book?

3. How can this group encourage each other's faith journey?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

HEBREWS 11:8

"Hebrews 11:8"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Hebrews 11:8

Write out from memory: Exodus 3:11

Write out from memory: Esther 4:14

Write out from memory: 1 Samuel 16:7

Write out from memory: Daniel 1:8

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which hero's faith most challenged you?

How has this study changed how you see faith?

Write a prayer to have a heart like the heroes who followed God.

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Study Notes

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